



Fibre in telecom (Image courtesy: <http://kinovo.qq>)

WIRELINE TEST EQUIPMENT: Moving On From Copper To Fibre Optics



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Although wireless communication is in vogue across most industries today, wireline cables still play an important role in the telecom industry. With the good-old copper wires gradually losing their sheen owing to signal losses, much more efficient optical fibres are paving the way for development in the telecom market. And so is the case with test and measurement equipment as well.

The market scenario

A few major test and measurement players such as Keysight, Rohde & Schwarz and National Instruments have gradually exited the wireline test equipment market either by discontinuing the manufacturing of these equipment or by selling their existing portfolio to a third party. On being asked about the reasons, these companies cite that wireline test equipment are becoming obsolete with industries switching to wireless technology.

At the same time, there are companies which are now leading the show in wireline test and measurement. These include the likes of Anritsu, INVAS technology, VIAVI and EXFO. The wireline market is still active and con-

stantly needs innovation—explained Neeraj Dhawan owner of INVAS Technologies.

Google had set up Google Fiber division in the year 2009 in select units of the USA (Kansas City) to provide broadband Internet services, home phone services and television services. This was a major hit during the trial phase itself and was later launched in 2012. The service is active till date.

Neeraj Dhawan, shared that one of the largest Indian telecom service providers is planning to provide 1Gbps speed in suburban areas of Mumbai using fibre optics, thus creating plenty of scope for wireline test equipment. “Copper wires are being replaced with these optical fibres by service providers like MTNL and Airtel,” said Dhawan.

“Manufacturers are also coming up with upgrades in wireline test equipment,” added Madhukar Tripathi, senior manager, marketing and channel sales, Anritsu India.

What's new?

As the interest has shifted from copper wires/coaxial cables to fibre optics, test and measurement players have introduced